

Risk Management Policy

SECTIONS 1-5: PURPOSE, SCOPE, DEFINITIONS, PRINCIPLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

1 PURPOSE

To establish a structured and proactive approach to identifying, assessing, managing, and monitoring risks across all areas of operation within Chosanta Management. The goal is to protect service users, staff, visitors, property, reputation, and business continuity while ensuring legal and regulatory compliance.

2 SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, agency staff, contractors, volunteers, and management personnel. It encompasses all service areas including residential care, administration, financial operations, health and safety, and regulatory compliance.

3 DEFINITIONS

- ✓ **Risk:** The chance of something happening that will have an impact on the achievement of objectives
- ✓ **Risk Assessment:** The process of evaluating and prioritising risks to determine how they should be managed
- ✓ **Risk Register:** A central record of all identified risks, their impact, likelihood, controls, and mitigation actions

4 PRINCIPLES

- ✓ Promote a risk-aware culture across all levels of the organisation
- ✓ Identify, assess, and manage risks in a timely and systematic manner
- ✓ Comply with HIQA regulations, the Health Act 2007, and the National Standards
- ✓ Ensure accountability for risk ownership and control implementation
- ✓ Continuously review and improve risk management practices

5 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Board / Management:** Oversee and support the implementation of the risk management framework
- ✓ **Person in Charge (PIC):** Ensure operational risks are identified, documented, and managed effectively
- ✓ **Staff:** Report potential risks or hazards immediately and follow agreed control measures
- ✓ **H&S Representative:** Monitor physical and environmental risks and ensure controls are in place

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SECTIONS 6–10: IDENTIFICATION, ASSESSMENT, CONTROLS, MONITORING & TRAINING

6 RISK IDENTIFICATION

- ✓ **Operational:** Staffing shortages, medication errors, equipment failure
- ✓ **Health & Safety:** Fire hazards, manual handling injuries, infection control breaches
- ✓ **Financial:** Funding instability, fraud, unapproved spending
- ✓ **Reputational:** Media exposure, service complaints, regulatory breaches
- ✓ **Strategic:** Service model changes, partnership failures, planning restrictions

7 RISK ASSESSMENT & EVALUATION

Rating	Score	Action
Low	1–5	Acceptable — monitor
Medium	6–12	Requires action and review
High	13–25	Immediate action required

Risk Rating = Likelihood (1–5) × Impact (1–5) = Total Risk Score

8 CONTROL MEASURES

- ✓ Policies and procedures
- ✓ Staff training and supervision
- ✓ Equipment maintenance and inspections
- ✓ Emergency response planning
- ✓ Regular audits and reviews

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Risk Register reviewed monthly by management
- ✓ All incidents and near misses analysed for trends
- ✓ Policy reviewed annually or following serious incidents, legal changes, or service expansion

10 TRAINING

- ✓ The importance of risk management
- ✓ How to identify and report risks
- ✓ Use of risk assessment tools and forms
- ✓ Emergency response procedures